Perineal Care

Goal:

This procedure will increase nursing skills, knowledge and confidence of the student nurse in assessing perineal area through a better understanding of performing systematic perineal care

Objectives:-

By the end of this procedure, the student nurse should be able to:

1- Identify the perineum and perineal care.

2- List the purpose of perineal care.

3- Describe the technique of perineal care.

Out Lines:

1- Introduction

2- Definition.

3- Purpose of Perineal care

4- Indication &contraindication

5- When Perineal care provided?

6- Equipment.

7- Assessment.

8- Technique of Perineal care

Introduction: -

The perineum is the skin located around the genitals and

rectum this area is dark, warm, and often moist, that conditions favor the bacterial growth and production of odors. Perineal care involves through cleansing of the woman's external genitalia and the surrounding skin.

Definition of perineal care:

- It is defined as the care of the external genitalia and the surrounding area in order to maintain the perineal hygiene.

-It is an external irrigation, cleansing and or swabbing of the vulva and perineum.

Purposes: -

1. To clean the perineum.
2. To relieve inflammation.
3. To relieve pain.
4. To stimulate circulation.
5. To prevent the spread of infection and bacterial growth.
6. To promote rapid healing.
7. To apply medication over episiotomy wound and any other perineal wound.
8. To promote a sense of well-being and comfort.

Indications:

1- before, during and after any procedure in the perineum area .like PV examination, episiotomy and catheterization and Postnatal mothers, then for:

2- Women who are unable to do self-care.

3- Women with genitourinary tract infection.

4- Women with excessive vaginal discharge.

5- Women after surgery on genitourinary tract and after abortion.

Contraindication: -

-Before wet smear (swab) perineal care should not be done.

Equipment:

1- Disposable gloves. 2-Wash basin, worm water

3- Antiseptic solution. 4-Bed ban and rubber sheet.

5- Cotton balls and tissue forceps. 6-Towels and wash clothes

7- Paper tissue. 8- Bath blanket or sheet

9-Perineal pad. 10-Paper bag for soiled dressing and pads.

Assessment:

1- Assess the history of any genital, urinary or rectal pathology.

2- Assess the women's previous genital cleansing practices.

3- Assess the women's genital area for signs of infection inflammation.

4- Assess women's knowledge of importance of perineal hygiene.

N.B:

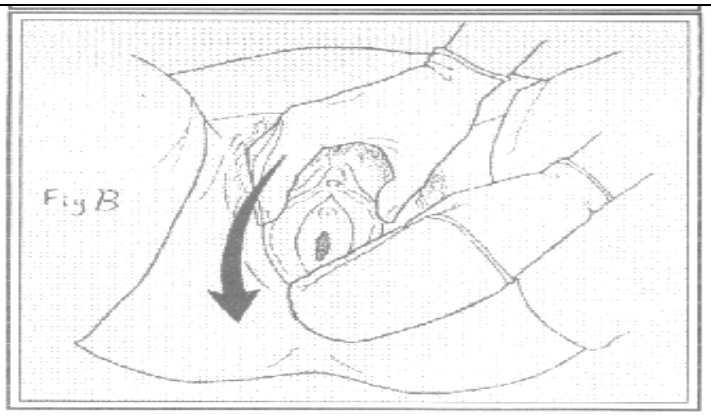
- ✓ Details of the technique vary from hospital to hospital.
- ✓ Swabbing is done from front to back.

Perineal care

Nursing action	Rational
1-Introduse yourself and explain procedure to woman.	- To gain cooperation, helps minimize anxiety during procedure.
2-Screen the bed and close room door.	- Maintain woman's privacy.
3- Provide the woman with the opportunity to empty her bladder and bowels prior to the procedure.	- Provides for the woman's comfort.
4- Wash hands.	- To prevent spread of infection.
5- Lower side rail and assist woman in assuming dorsal recumbent position.	- Provides easy access to genitalia.
6- Wear gloves.	
7-Assess the woman's genital area for color, odor, lesions, masses, swelling, irritation, tenderness, and discharge.	- Provide information for planning care.
8- Remove gloves, discard it and assist the woman to a comfortable position.	
9- Wash hands.	- To prevent spread of infection.
10-Assemple equipment at bedside.	- To organize task.
11-Raise bed to comfortable working position.	- Facilitate good body mechanism.

12- Put mackintosh and towel under the woman's buttocks then place the bed pan.	- To protect the bed linen.
13- Drape the woman by placing the bath blanket with one corner between the woman's leg, one corner pointing toward each side of bed, and one corner over the woman's chest.	- Draping prevents unnecessary I exposure of body parts and maintains woman's warmth and comfort during procedure.
14- Fill wash basin with warm water and antiseptic solution and place wash clothes or dressing in the basin.	
15- Ask the woman to flex her knees and spread her legs apart.	- Provides full exposure of female genitalia.
16- Done disposable gloves. Fold the lower corner of the bath blanket onto her abdomen.	- To minimize the spread of infection. -Keeping client draped until procedure begins minimize anxiety.
17- Remove the soiled perineal pad or dressing from **above to downward** and place it in the paper bag.	- To observe vaginal discharge or lochia, condition of vulva and episiotomy.
18- Flush the perineal area with warm water or antiseptic solution until the area is clean in the following way: - a) Clean the mons pubis **upward** from	

far side to the near side. b) Clean far thigh beginning **from inside to outside**. c) Clean the near thigh in the same manner. d) Clean the far labia from the level of clitoris **downward** to the level of anus. e) Clean the near labia in the same way. f) Clean the introitus (in between the two labia) by single **downward** motion from top to bottom. g) Clean vagina opening by **circular motion.** h) Clean anus also by **a circular motion**.	**Figure 4.4.1** Female Perineal Care (Image Courtesy of HCA Program/ TRU
19- Wash the perineum with antiseptic solution with a wash clothes or cotton balls by **the same way of cleaning** using the same sequence and techniques using a sterile gloves or use an artery forceps.	- Cleansing method reduces transfer of microorganisms to urinary meatus.
21-Dry the perineal area by the same way of cleaning using the same sequence and techniques.	- Moist is a good media for growth of microorganisms.

 fig. A: Cleansing the introitus. Fig. B: Cleansing the anus.	
22- Remove the bed ban and dry buttocks with dressing or wash cloth.	- To minimize growth of microorganism.
23-Aplly clean dry bad from up to down without touching the surface close to the woman.	
24- Remove and dispose gloves (discard it)	- To prevent cross infection.
25- Rearrange bed, clothes and make the woman comfortable.	
26-Wash hands.	To minimize remove any microorganism.
27-Record and chart a) Time of perineal care given b) Type of solution c) Observation on vulva & perineum, any abnormalities and response of woman. d) Color, odor, amount and consistency of vaginal discharge or lochia.	
28-Give health teaching about self-	-To help continuity

perineal care.	of care. -To prevent complication

Perineal Care Checklist

Action	First Trial		Second Trial	
	Done	Note Done	Done	Note Done
1-lntroduse yourself and explain procedure				

to woman.				
2-Screen the bed and close room door.				
3- Provide the woman with the opportunity to empty bladder and bowels prior to the procedure.				
4-Wash hands.				
5-Lower side rail and assist woman in assuming dorsal recumbent position.				
6- Wear gloves.				
7-Assess the woman's genital area for color, odor, lesions, masses, swelling, irritation, tenderness, and discharge.				
8- Wash hands.				
9-Assemple equipment at bedside.				
10-Raise bed to comfortable working position.				
11- Put mackintosh under the woman's buttocks and place the bed pan.				
12- Drape the woman by placing the bath blanket in a diamond shape.				
13- Fill wash basin with warm water and antiseptic solution and place dressing in the basin.				
14- Ask the woman to flex her knees and spread her legs apart.				
15- Fold the lower corner of the bath blanket onto her abdomen.				
16- Remove the soiled perineal pad and place it in the paper bag.				
17- Clean the perineal area with warm water or antiseptic solution until the area is				

clean in the following way: - a) Clean the mons veneris upward from far side to the near side. b) Clean far thigh beginning from inside to outside. c) Clean the near thigh in the same manner. d) Clean the far labia from the level of clitoris downward to anus level. e) Clean the near labia in the same way. f) Clean the introitus by single downward motion from top to bottom. g) clean the vaginal opening then the anus by circular motion.				
18- Wash the perineum with antiseptic solution by wash clothes or forceps and cotton balls in the same way of cleaning using the same technique.				
19- Rinse and dry the perineal area using the same sequence and technique.				
20-Remove the bed ban, turn woman on bed and dry buttocks with cotton sponges.				
21-Apply clean dry perineal pad from up to down without touching the surface close to the woman.				
22- Rearrange bed, clothes and make the woman comfortable.				
23- Removes gloves and wash hands.				
24-Record and chart a) Time b) Type of solution				

c) Observation on vulva & perineum, any abnormalities and response of woman. d) Color, odor, amount and consistency of lochia.				
25-Give health teaching about self-perineal care.				
Procedure score				
Date				

Student signature: **Instructor signature:**

Portogram

Goal:

At the end of this lecture, each student should acquire complete knowledge, skills and positive attitude toward portogram and